



This month's winner is
Debangshu Sen
Burdwan
West Bengal

He wins
**Windows XP
in 10 Simple
Steps or Less**
by Wiley
Publishing Inc.



WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift just by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should be shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier. E-mail your picture with the subject 'DigiPick' and your postal address **on or before 15th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

DRUNKEN SURVEY

The Dire Consequences Of IT Stress

First it was our jobs, then it was our spouses, and now (as if we didn't expect this), it's IT. British charity Developing Patient Partners claims that IT problems—from crashing computers to irritating cell-phones—have become a popular modern excuse for turning to alcoholism. They carried out a survey of 1,000 people, a third of whom confirmed that IT hassles get them stressed out, causing many even to light up a trusty cigarette to escape all of it.

They have also noted, quite shocked, that 64 per cent of people think that stress is a disease (it's actually a *condition* that makes you vulnerable to diseases), and that one-third of people turn to alcohol in times of stress. In all the hoo-hah, we fail to find any mention of the exact number of people surveyed who had actually turned to alcohol in the

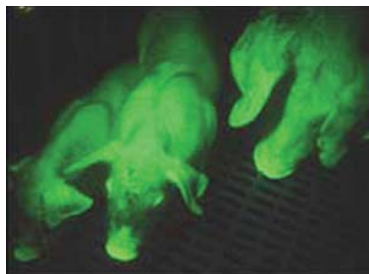
face of a BSOD. So, what is the survey trying to say?

We have all, of course, known for long that the PC can be the most frustrating thing since the Chinese finger-trap, but really, couldn't you just throw it out the window like regular people do?

GLOW-IN-THE-DARK SAVIOURS

Fluoro-Piggies And The Good Of Humankind

Scientists in Taiwan claim that they have bred three pigs that—believe it or not—glow in the dark! By taking some genetic material from jellyfish, adding it to



Yes, these are pigs!

around 265 pig embryos and implanting them in eight female pigs, they have found themselves with the lucky three who survived it all to become world-famous. Under blue light, the cute little tykes are said to glow as bright as a torch.

Taiwan isn't tomtomming about being the first to do this, though, because to our great surprise and amusement, they aren't! Yes, the glowing pig idea is quite an old one, but all that had been managed thus far was only a skin-deep glow. This new breed of pig is the first to be fluorescent inside out—even their internal organs glow in the dark.

Despite the undoubted entertainment one can derive from glowy farm animals, they have actually been bred for a very noble cause—stem-cell research and the analysis of human disease. Humans and pigs have a lot in common: notably, their hearts are similar. By using stem-cells from these pigs in humans, scientists will eliminate the need for complex surgical procedures to track the progress of these cells,

People Who Changed Computing

Winamp Whizkid

With the slew of media players available today, it's easy to forget the Original MP3 Player that literally launched MP3—Winamp. Justin Frankel was just a



Justin Frankel

teenager when he was working on Winamp. He showed promise with computers as a youngster, and was

already using "Nullsoft," the name of his software company, for the software he was creating at school. It was reported that in 1998 Frankel worked like a madman at Winamp, coding all day and surviving on pizza, and saying "outside's overrated!"

Frankel launched the first version of Winamp under Nullsoft in 1997. Initially launched as shareware at \$10 (Rs 440), Winamp was a huge success. Millions of people downloaded the program, and the revenue it generated ran into the tens of thousands of dollars! Although Frankel sold Nullsoft to AOL in 1999, he continued working on subsequent versions of Winamp, and completed Winamp version 5.0 in late 2003—just before he resigned from AOL.

Frankel's second work of consequence was the Gnutella P2P which he created with his partner, Tom Peppers. The system was similar to Napster; Gnutella, however, had two advantages over Napster. First, it allowed users to share all kinds of files, and not just MP3s. Also, Gnutella did not have centralised servers, so once the network was created, it could not be shut off.

After resigning from AOL, Frankel has been working on several projects, including a software called 'NINJAM' that allows several people to make real music via the Internet, and REAPER, a multi-track audio editor for Windows.